



QColorPrefs

A Color Theme Utility For QSpice

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Overview

QColorPrefs is a free, open-source command-line utility that lets you save, restore, and switch between multiple QSpice schematic and waveform color preferences. Share color themes with colleagues, back up your settings before experiments, or maintain multiple color schemes for different projects.

Features:

- Save all color settings to portable text files
- Restore settings from saved files
- Selective save/restore (schematic or waveform settings only)
- Update existing color theme files with current registry values
- Test mode to preview changes before applying them
- Verbose mode to see exactly what changes
- Silent mode to suppress confirmation prompts for use in batch files
- Human-readable file format with inline comments
- Includes user-contributed sample themes.

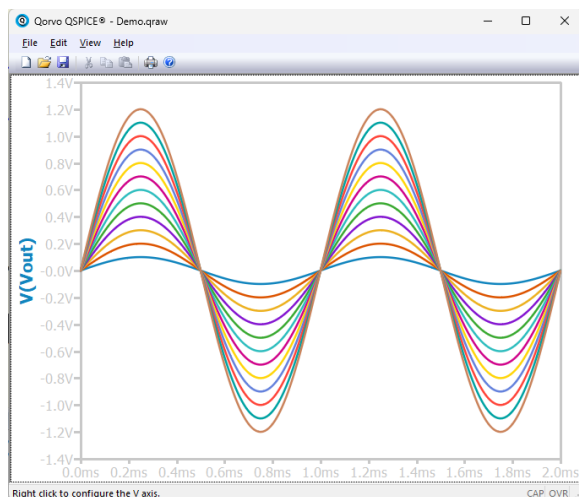


Figure 1: Example Light Theme

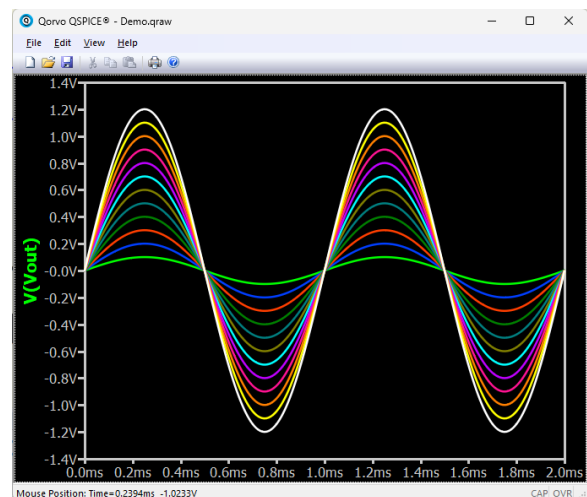


Figure 2: Example Dark Theme

Installing/Uninstalling QColorPrefs

The complete QColorPrefs project code and documentation is available at:
<https://github.com/robdunn4/QSpice/>.

You have a few options:

- Install using the MSI installer (recommended).
- Copy the command-line binaries and related files from the repository.
- Build the project from sources.

Install With MSI

The MSI installation is recommended. You get the required files, sample themes, and the command line utility. The installer registers theme files (*.qcolorpref) so that you can switch between themes easily by double-clicking on the desired theme in File Explorer.

Download QColorPrefs_Installer.msi to a convenient folder. Double-click in File Explorer. Choose an installation folder. (The default location is [C:\QColorPrefs](#). I don't recommend installing in a system folder such as "[C:\Program Files](#)" due to elevated rights requirements.)

The installed files include:

- QColorPrefs.exe – The command-line utility. Run "QColorPrefs.exe -?" for a syntax summary.
- @Command_Prompt.bat – Double-click this file in File Explorer to open a command prompt to run QColorPrefs.exe commands.
- @MyBackup.bat – Batch file used during installation to create MyBackup.qcolorpref containing the current QSpice theme data in case you want to restore your original settings.
- Documentation files – readme.txt, license.txt.
- Sample themes (*.qcolorpref files). Note: These files are deleted when QColorPrefs is uninstalled or updated. I suggest that you create copies if you want to modify them.

Once installed, you can double-click on a theme file to apply the settings to the QSpice registry entries. If QSpice is open, close and reopen it for the theme settings to take effect.

Download Binaries

The Binaries repository folder contains the same files that would be installed with the MSI installer. However, it doesn't create the registry file association entries so you can't apply themes by double-clicking in File Explorer. You'll need to use the command-line tool to apply a theme.

Be sure to create a backup of your current settings (use @MyBackup.bat).

Compile From Sources

The Sources repository folder contains the MSVS 2026 project files. Feel free to download and compile them yourself.

Creating/Editing Themes

Theme files (*.qcolorpref) contain schematic and/or waveform settings in a simple text format. You can edit them with any text editor (e.g., Notepad). However, the least risky approach is to modify settings in the QSpice GUI and use the command-line tool to generate a theme file from the current settings. Then edit the theme file to comment out any settings that you don't want to change when the theme is applied.

See the next section for information about using the command-line tool. See Appendix A For an example of a theme file.

Command-Line Syntax

To use the command-line tool (QColorPrefs.exe), open a command prompt window in the folder where you installed QColorPrefs or double-click on @Command_Prompt.bat from File Explorer.

Run "QColorPrefs.exe -?" to see the synax as well as version information. It looks like this:

```
QColorPrefs v1.7 [Thu Feb 19 17:06:48 2026]

Usage: QColorPrefs [options] <action> <filepath>

<action>:
-sall  Save all QSpice registry color settings to file
-ssch  Save only schematic color settings to file
-swav  Save only waveform color settings to file

-uall  Update all existing entries in file with current registry values
-usch  Update only existing schematic entries in file with current registry values
-uwav  Update only existing waveform entries in file with current registry values

-rall  Restore all QSpice registry color settings from file
-rwav  Restore only waveform color settings from file
-rsch  Restore only schematic color settings from file

[options]:
-?  Show command-line syntax
-v  (Verbose Mode) Show per-value before/after changes
-t  (Test Mode) Show what would happen without making changes
-s  (Silent Mode) Suppress user confirmation prompts

If no file extension is provided, '.qcolorpref' will be added automatically.
The -v option can be combined with any other option for verbose output.
The -t option shows actions without making changes (dry-run mode).
The -s option suppresses confirmation prompts. Save, update, and restore
operations will not prompt the user for permission before applying
the changes. (Intended for use in batch scripts and Desktop shortcuts.
Use with caution.)
```

The Save operations (-sall, -ssch, -swav) copy the current QSpice settings from the registry to a theme file. You will be prompted if the theme file exists (unless you use the -s switch).

The Update operations (-uall, -usch, -uwav) modify an existing theme file. Settings that exist in the theme file are updated to match the current QSpice registry settings. Where the Save operations

essentially overwrite the theme file with current settings, the Update operations do not add new entries to the theme. You will be prompted before making changes to the theme file (unless you use the -s switch).

The Restore operations (-rall, -rsch, -rwav) copy settings from the theme file to the QSpice registry entries. Any QSpice settings not present in the theme file (or commented out) remain unchanged. You will be prompted before the settings are restored (unless you use the -s switch).

The Verbose switch (-v) shows detailed information about what will be settings will be changed.

The Test switch (-t) performs a “dry run.” That is, no changes will be made to the registry or theme file. It is most commonly used with the Verbose switch.

License

This project is made available under the GNU General Public License v3. See <https://www.gnu.org/licenses/> for full details.

Acknowledgements

Many thanks to QSpice forum user @KSKelvin for providing sample themes and for his incredible community support for QSpice.

About Support

This project is not an official part of QSpice. It is a product solely of my personal efforts and not supported by Qorvo or QSpice. If you have questions, concerns, comments, improvements, etc., please contact me (@RDunn) on the QSpice forum.

Conclusion

I hope that you find this tool to be useful. And, of course, let me know if you find problems or have suggestions for improving the code or this documentation.

--robert

Appendix A

Example Theme File

Theme files are simple text files containing schematic and/or waveform settings. Comments begin with ‘#’. Color codes are in 0xBBGGRR format (Blue, Green, Red). Edit carefully – QColorPrefs does not ensure that values are sensible.

```
# This file was created by QColorPrefs v1.7 on February 24, 2026 at 11:58 AM
# Generated automatically - do not edit unless you know what you're doing
# Save operations are complete replacements and comments are not preserved
# Update operations attempt to preserve line comments within header sections
```

```
[schematic]
CADHighlightColor=0x326464      # Highlight Color
CADBackgroundColor=0xe9ffff     # Background
CADbomberSight=0x000000        # Schematic Grid Color
CADgrapicAnnotation=0xff0000   # Graphic Annotation Color
CADsolidAnnotation=0x00ffff    # Solid Annotation Fill Color
CADgrapicText=0xff0000        # Symbol Graphic Text Color
CADnormalText=0x000000        # Component Text Color
CADnormalSchText=0x000000     # Schematic Text Color
CADcommentText=0xff0000       # Comment Text Color
CADnetLabelText=0x0000ff      # Net Label Color
CADwireColor=0xff0000         # Wire Color
CADhighlightWireColor=0x64e1e1 # Highlight Wire Color
CADpinDotColor=0x000000       # Pin Dot Color
CADspritedAnchor=0x00ffff     # Sprited Anchor Color
CADpinColor=0x000000         # Pin Color Color [sic]
CADportBkColor=0xffffffff     # Port Background Color
CADhierarchalBlock=0xff0000   # Hierarchical Box Color
CADhierarchalFill=0xc8c8c8    # Hierarchical Fill Color
CADunconnectedPin=0xffffffff  # Unconnected Pin Color
CADbusTapError=0x0000ff      # Incorrect Bus Tap Color
JunctionSize=1.0             # Junction Size
CADlinewidth=1.5             # CAD Line Width
BUSwidthMultiplier=2.0       # Bus Width Multiplier
DefaultTextSize=1.0          # Default Text Size
```

```
[waveform]
NumberDataTraceColors=12      # Number of Trace Colors
CursorBackFore=0xffffffff    # Attached Cursor Text Color
CursorBackGnd=0x0000ff       # Attached Cursor Background
CursorLineColor=0xc8c8c8     # Cursor Color
FrameColor=0xc8c8c8          # Ticks & Axis Color
BackgroundColor=0xffffffff    # Background Color
WaveFormViewerFontPoints=120 # Font Point Size
WaveformPlotLineWidth=2.5    # Plot Line Thickness
DataColor1=0xdd8c26          # Waveform Trace #1 Color
DataColor2=0x2877f5          # Waveform Trace #2 Color
DataColor3=0x64e8ff          # Waveform Trace #3 Color
DataColor4=0xfb5cc0          # Waveform Trace #4 Color
DataColor5=0x40db49          # Waveform Trace #5 Color
DataColor6=0xfff46c          # Waveform Trace #6 Color
DataColor7=0xc567f2          # Waveform Trace #7 Color
DataColor8=0x4cc0fe          # Waveform Trace #8 Color
DataColor9=0xffa97d          # Waveform Trace #9 Color
DataColor10=0x747aff         # Waveform Trace #10 Color
DataColor11=0xbecf1e         # Waveform Trace #11 Color
DataColor12=0x6c99dc         # Waveform Trace #12 Color
DataColor13=0x00ff00         # Waveform Trace #13 Color
DataColor14=0xff3f00         # Waveform Trace #14 Color
DataColor15=0x003fff         # Waveform Trace #15 Color
DataColor16=0x008000         # Waveform Trace #16 Color
```

DataColor17=0x807f00
DataColor18=0x007f80
DataColor19=0x00ff00
DataColor20=0xff3f00
DataColor21=0x003fff
DataColor22=0x008000
DataColor23=0x807f00
DataColor24=0x007f80

Waveform Trace #17 Color
Waveform Trace #18 Color
Waveform Trace #19 Color
Waveform Trace #20 Color
Waveform Trace #21 Color
Waveform Trace #22 Color
Waveform Trace #23 Color
Waveform Trace #24 Color